
Attendance, Leave & Payroll Enhancement Plan

A Feature Roadmap for Restaurant & F&B Hospitality Operations
Kitchen | Service Floor | Bar | Multi-Outlet Operations

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Executive Summary

This document outlines a roadmap to bring the Attendance, Leave Management, and Payroll modules of the Smart Teams workforce platform to a best-in-class standard, purpose-built for a restaurant / F&B hospitality business — kitchen, service floor, bar, and (where applicable) multiple outlets. Rather than adapting a generic office attendance-and-payroll system, every feature below is designed around the operating rhythm of a food-service business: meal-period rushes, split shifts, tip pooling, station-based staffing, and the need for managers to see the real cost and coverage impact of every leave or overtime decision before it happens. The goal is a system that feels built for how the floor and kitchen actually run — not retrofitted from a corporate-office template.

The roadmap is organized into three functional areas (Attendance, Leave Management, Payroll) and a four-phase delivery plan. Each feature includes a short explanation of what it does and why it matters operationally, so this document can be reviewed and approved without requiring technical background.

Section 1 — Attendance

1. Meal-Period Shift Matching

Attendance is checked against breakfast, lunch, and dinner (or brunch/late-night) shift blocks instead of a single fixed office schedule. Late arrivals and early departures are measured against the specific rush period an employee is rostered for, giving an accurate picture of punctuality during the hours that matter most.

2. Station-Based Clock-In

Kitchen staff clock in against a station (grill, prep, dessert, dish) and service staff against a section (floor, bar, takeout counter). This ties attendance directly to what role or station someone is covering that shift, not just a generic “present” status.

3. Duty Roster Per Outlet

For businesses with more than one outlet — multiple restaurants, a bar, or a small chain — each location maintains its own weekly roster, with staff able to float between outlets when needed.

4. Split Shifts

Supports multiple clock-in/clock-out pairs in a single day (for example, 10 AM–2 PM for lunch service, off, then 6 PM–11 PM for dinner service) — a standard pattern in F&B that a single-session attendance model cannot represent correctly.

5. Shift-Swap Between Peers

Staff can request to trade shifts with a colleague, subject to manager approval. This reflects day-to-day floor reality, and attendance automatically follows the swapped roster rather than the original one.

6. Minimum-Coverage Alerting Per Station/Shift

The system flags a request if approving it would drop a station below its required minimum — for example, fewer than two line cooks during dinner rush — so managers see the operational impact before approving, not after.

7. Overtime & Late-Night Differential Flagging

Overtime hours and late-night hours are automatically tagged at the point of attendance, closing a common cost leak where extra hours worked during unexpected rushes go unnoticed until payroll is already run.

8. Casual / Event / Banquet-Hall Staffing Attendance

For temporary staff brought in for private events or banquet functions, a lightweight per-event clock-in is available — separate from the standing roster, so temporary staffing never has to be forced into the permanent-employee attendance flow.

Section 2 — Leave Management

1. Coverage-Aware Approval

When a manager reviews a leave request, the system shows the resulting staffing level for that shift and station — preventing situations where several approvals stack up and leave a shift critically understaffed without anyone noticing until the day arrives.

2. Blackout / Peak-Period Restrictions

Predictable high-demand dates — holidays, festival weekends, major reservation nights — can be marked as restricted per outlet, separate from standard public holidays, so leave requests during critical business periods are automatically flagged or blocked.

3. Role/Station-Specific Leave Policies

Kitchen staff, service staff, and management can each have different leave entitlements and notice-period requirements, reflecting the different operational impact of each role being away.

4. Self-Serve “Who's Already Off” Calendar

Staff can check who else on their outlet or station already has approved time off before submitting their own request, reducing back-and-forth submit-then-reject cycles.

5. Casual-Staff Exclusion From Standard Accrual

Event-based and casual workers are automatically handled outside the standard leave-accrual rules that apply to permanent staff, avoiding incorrect balances for staff who are not on a standing schedule.

6. Comp-Off for Event Overtime

Staff pulled in for a major banquet or event weekend can earn compensatory time off instead of (or alongside) overtime pay, credited as a distinct leave-balance entry.

Section 3 — Payroll

1. Tip Pooling / Service-Charge Distribution

Pooled tips or service charge are automatically split across kitchen and service staff using a transparent points system (hours worked, role, seniority) — replacing the opaque spreadsheet calculations that are a common source of staff disputes.

2. Late-Night & Split-Shift Allowances

Allowances for late-night and split-shift work are applied automatically, based directly on the hours flagged during attendance, removing manual entry and reducing payroll-run errors.

3. Overtime Pay Tied to Actual Flagged Hours

Overtime pay is computed from the overtime hours already flagged during attendance, rather than a manual monthly adjustment that is easy to get wrong or forget.

4. Meal & Uniform Allowances

Standard F&B-industry pay components — meal allowance, uniform/laundry allowance — configurable per role, so they can be applied consistently without manual calculation each pay cycle.

5. Casual / Per-Event Payout

Event and casual staff are paid per shift or per event through a dedicated payout path, running alongside — but separate from — the standard monthly payroll cycle for permanent employees.

6. Per-Outlet Labor Cost & Prime Cost Reporting

Labor cost (and, where food cost data is available, combined prime cost) is reported as a percentage of revenue, broken down by outlet — the number an owner or operator watches most closely, week to week.

7. Leave-Deduction Accuracy for Split-Shift/Casual Pay

Leave-deduction calculations correctly account for split-shift and per-event pay structures, instead of assuming every employee is on a flat monthly salary with a standard working-day count.

8. Payslip Transparency for Tips/Service Charge

Every employee can see, directly on their payslip, exactly how their tip or service-charge share was calculated — the points earned, hours counted, and total pool amount — reducing disputes and building trust in the payout process.

Section 4 — Phased Implementation Roadmap

Delivery is organized into four phases, each building on the previous one. Earlier phases establish the operational foundation that later phases depend on.

Phase	Focus	Key Deliverables
Phase 1 Foundation	Establish the operational building blocks	• Outlet and station/role structure • Duty roster engine per outlet • Shift-based attendance matching (meal periods, split shifts) • Extended pay-component support for allowances
Phase 2 F&B-Specific Core	Build the features unique to food-service operations	• Shift-swap requests + coverage-aware leave approval • Tip pooling / service-charge distribution engine • Payslip transparency for tips/service charge • Casual/event staffing path (attendance & payroll)
Phase 3 Policy Sophistication	Refine rules to match real operating policy	• Role/station-specific leave policies • Blackout/peak-period calendar per outlet • Comp-off accrual for event overtime • Overtime/late-night auto-flagging feeding into payroll
Phase 4 Reporting	Give ownership the numbers that matter	• Per-outlet labor cost & prime cost reporting • Leave-approval vs. overtime-backfill correlation analysis

Client Approval

Please review the feature roadmap outlined in this document. Approval below confirms agreement to proceed with the phased implementation plan as described in Section 4.

Approved By (Name):

Title / Role:

Signature:

Date:

Comments / Requested Changes:

This document is intended as a planning and approval reference. Timelines and effort estimates for each phase can be discussed separately once the feature scope above is confirmed.